

MERIDIAN DIGITAL FORENSICS

Forensic Examination Report

Matter Reference:	VDI-2025-0503 (Retained by Bregman & Voss LLP, outside counsel)
Custodian:	Marcus D. Ostrow
Devices Examined:	Vantek-issued laptop (Asset #VD-4471), Vantek-issued mobile phone (Asset #VD-4472)
Examination Dates:	May 5-7, 2025
Examiner:	J. Whitcombe, Senior Forensic Analyst, Meridian Digital Forensics
Report Date:	May 7, 2025

1. Scope and Methodology

A forensic image of the custodian's Company-issued laptop and mobile phone was acquired on May 6, 2025 using a write-blocked hardware imaging device, following standard chain-of-custody procedures. This report summarizes findings from analysis of file system metadata, USB device connection logs, and repository access logs for the period January 1, 2025 through May 6, 2025.

2. Key Findings

2.1 External Storage Device Connection. A USB mass storage device (Serial: SNDK-88231-A) was connected to the custodian's laptop on April 30, 2025 at 23:41:12 local time and remained connected for approximately 38 minutes. Approximately 2.31 GB of data was written to the device during this window.

2.2 Files Transferred (partial list, by filename).

Filename	Size	Source Location
Kestrel_Core_Algorithm_v4.2.zip	684 MB	\\eng-repo\actuators\kestrel\core
Torque_Compensation_Source.tar.gz	512 MB	\\eng-repo\actuators\kestrel\core
Kestrel_Control_Spec_v3.pdf	8 MB	\\eng-repo\actuators\kestrel\specs
Coefficient_Tuning_Notebooks.zip	441 MB	\\eng-repo\actuators\kestrel\research
Marketing_OnePager_Kestrel.pptx	22 MB	\\eng-repo\actuators\kestrel\marketing

2.3 Repository Access Log. Access logs for the engineering repository (\\eng-repo\actuators\kestrel) show that the custodian's credentials (user: mostrow) accessed the **core** and **research** subdirectories - which contain the unfiled torque-compensation algorithm source code and associated tuning notebooks - on eleven (11) occasions between March 18, 2025 and April 30, 2025. Repository permission records indicate the custodian's role (Senior Firmware Engineer) had standing read/write access to these subdirectories; this access was not exceptional or the result of a permissions error.

2.4 Deletion Activity. No evidence of attempted deletion or wiping of local files was found on the imaged laptop as of the acquisition date.

3. Chain of Custody

Devices were received from T. Bayless (Vantek IT Security) on May 5, 2025 at 4:30 PM, imaged on May 6, 2025 between 9:00 AM and 1:15 PM, and returned to T. Bayless on May 6, 2025 at 2:00 PM. Full chain-of-custody log (Exhibit A) is maintained separately per Meridian Digital Forensics' standard evidence handling protocol.

This report was prepared at the direction of outside litigation counsel (Bregman & Voss LLP) in connection with anticipated litigation.